

The recruitment trend in the telecom sector further confirms that this is the right time to become a part of this booming sector. According to a recent study by PricewaterhouseCoopers (PwC), the telecom sector in India will provide employment to around ten million people by 2012. The sector will provide about 2,800,000 direct jobs and around 7,000,000 indirect jobs by next year, the study reveals. Titled *Indian Mobile Services Sector: Struggling to Maintain Sustainable Growth*, the study was commissioned by the Cellular Operators Association of India.

Vinay Grover, founder and CEO, Symbiosis Management Consultants, shares, "Most of the world's renowned companies have already entered India through joint ventures. With the launch of 3G, WiMAX and the planning being done for 4G, there is a huge demand for qualified and skilled professionals with knowledge and technical know-how in these fields. Also, with the upcoming projects, the telecom industry is making room for more than 5000 trained and experienced radio frequency engineers."

"The telecom revolution in India has been quite exceptional with so many new players entering the market and existing players expanding operations. While the sector has been one of the largest employers in the last decade, it would still need around 275,000 people by 2015. The challenge here would be to get the right talent," Grover adds.

"With the conviction of the Indian telecom industry's rapid evolution, the opportunities for engineering students are enormous. The telecom industry today needs large volumes of dedicated technical and business talent to meet aggressive growth targets," mentions Girish Johar, vice president, human resources and organisation, Ericsson India.

Johar continues, "Majority of the job opportunities are in the area of solutioning, product management, projects' roll-out and management, customer support, manufacturing and managed services, and remote infrastructure management."

Major players

MTNL and BSNL are the major public-sector players in India, whereas Bharti Airtel, Idea Cellular, Vodafone Essar, Tata and Reliance are the leading private-sector players. Some of them are entering foreign markets as well.

These and other companies offering jobs in the telecommunication sector are listed below:

- Aircel Cellular
- Aishwarya Telecom
- Aksh Optifibre
- Anco Communications
- Avaya GlobalConnect
- Bharti Airtel
- Bharti Teletech
- Eider Infotech
- Ericsson
- Esskay Telecom
- FCI DEN Connectors
- Finolex Cables
- Gemini Communications
- Goldstone Infratech
- GR Cables
- GTL Infrastructure
- Gujarat Optical Communication
- Hartron Communications
- Hathway Bhawani Cabletel & Datacom
- HFCL Infotel
- Himachal Futuristic Communications
- Hindustan Cables
- Idea Cellular
- Integrated Digital Info Services
- ITI
- Kaveri Telecom Products
- Krone Communications
- Mahanagar Telephone Nigam
- MIC Electronics
- Mobile Tele Communications
- Motorola MP Telelinks
- Munoth Communication
- Nelco
- Nokia India
- Nokia Siemens Networks
- Nortel
- Nu Tek India
- Optel Telecommunications
- Paramount Communications
- Precision Electronics
- Punjab Communications
- Qualcomm India
- Reliance Communications
- RPG Cables
- Shyam Telecom
- Spice Communications
- Spice Mobiles
- Sterlite Technologies
- Sujana Towers
- Surana Telecom & Power
- Surana Telecom
- Tamilnadu Telecommunications
- Tata Teleservices (Maharashtra)
- Tata Communications
- Telecom Regulatory Authority of India
- Telecommunications Consultants India
- Telephone Cables
- Tulip Telecom
- Valiant Communications
- Videsh Sanchar Nigam
- Vindhya Telelinks
- Vodafone Group Plc.
- XL Telecom & Energy

"There is likely to be a persistent demand for engineers in the industry, given the untapped potential still waiting to be explored and the entry of several new players in the fray. The demand will be mainly driven by vendor companies like Nokia Siemens, Ericsson, GTL, Alcatel Lucent and Huawei, among others," says Tarun Sapra, RF SME performance, Alcatel-Lucent.

There are several new companies which have been given pan-India 2G licences to conduct operations across all the sectors. New operators who have been granted licences include MTS, Swan, Uninor, Etisalat and DoCoMo among others. These companies will set up networks and start operations shortly, driving the demand for engi-

neers. Operators like Vodafone, Airtel, Idea and Reliance are laying more emphasis on enhancing their 3G network. They have also started working on long-term evolution (LTE) technology.

How to become a part of the communication chain?

Talking about the non-engineering positions, academicians, lawyers, MBAs, sales people and PR people are required in the telecom sector just as the techies who design and maintain the worldwide information network for the future. In order to qualify for an engineering job, one needs to be specialised either in electronics and communication engineering, computer science or electrical engineering. The